

Why reference?

Referencing is the acknowledgement of the sources of information you have used in creating your work. It indicates that the ideas or the words you have used are based on another person's work. Acknowledgement of your sources not only shows respect for the original author's intellectual rights, but is also essential to avoid plagiarism. In addition, referencing reminds the writer and details to the reader the source of information for further study, and can also add authority to your work by indicating the breadth of research.

How much detail is required?

Your teacher will indicate whether you only need to provide a bibliography, (ie a list of all the material used in the preparation of your work), or full referencing.

Full referencing, using a consistent system, is the expected standard for all academic writing. It requires that in addition to a bibliography or reference list at the end of your assignment, references are included within the text. They should be used whenever you use ideas, words or data from any other source. *This includes, not only direct quotes, but also putting someone else's ideas into your own words.*

Which system?

There are many different referencing systems. Check the [University of South Australia referencing guide](#) for an example of the variety of systems being used in different departments within one institution. The two most commonly used are the Harvard System, (author-date) and the Chicago System, (footnotes).

SACE uses the Harvard System in its guidelines for referencing, but acknowledges that other systems are used in schools and in specific subjects - it is stated in the guide that, *The basic purpose of all referencing styles is:*

1. *to acknowledge other people's words or ideas*
2. *to enable readers to find the material if they want to.*

The style should remain consistent throughout a piece of writing.

(SACE Board guidelines for referencing, 2011 accessible via the [SACE Research Advice page](#))

In general, use the Harvard System unless you are instructed to use the Chicago System. However, no matter which system is used it is most important that referencing is in a consistent style throughout an assignment.

Be prepared!

Many students leave the preparation of references until finalising an assignment and thus experience difficulties in locating the details required. Reference source details should be noted as works are consulted, (ie at the *locating* and *selecting* stages of the Information Process). It can be useful to have a standard form, similar to the Reference and note taking sheet, for gathering reference (bibliographic) information as you use a book, web site or any other type resource.